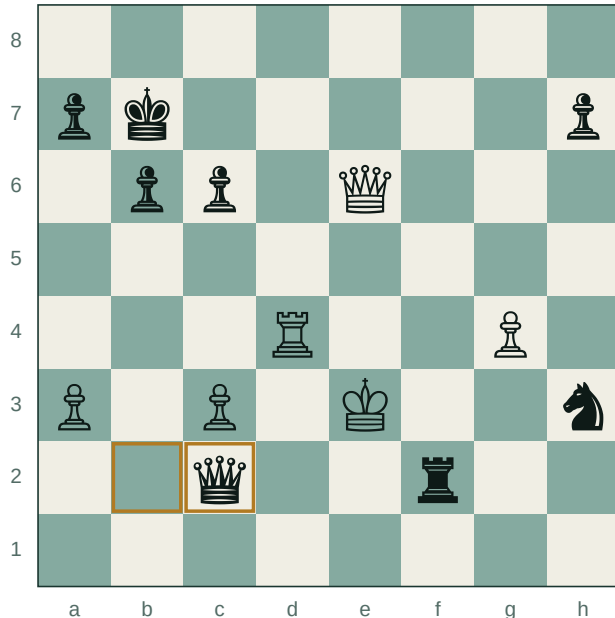


Deflection tactics: White, move 36

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 35...Qxc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36. Rd7+ Ka6 37. Qc4+ b5 38. Qxc6+ Ka5 39. Rxa7#

36.Rd7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36...Ka6**.

37.Qc4+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **37...b5**.

38.Qxc6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on c6. Recorded reply: **38...Ka5**.

39.Rxa7# Mate: rook on a7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on b7. Geometrically undefended: knight on h3. Check for tactical protection.